

# API Usage Tracking Guide

Why the API-key usage pages can look empty, and every way to make them work — including the locally-measured ledger that is already wired in and needs no special key at all.

Written 15 July 2026 · applies to AI Account Manager 1.1 and later

## 1 Why the pages show nothing

The app asks each provider's billing API for your spend. For most providers that data is simply **not offered to normal API keys** — it is a provider-side restriction, not an app bug. A standard key can prove it is *valid* (the app checks the models endpoint), but the usage endpoints answer 401/403.

| PROVIDER           | NORMAL KEY             | WHAT REAL USAGE DATA NEEDS                                                                     |
|--------------------|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Anthropic          | X <b>validate-only</b> | An <b>Admin key</b> ( <code>sk-ant-admin...</code> ) for the organization cost & usage reports |
| OpenAI             | X <b>validate-only</b> | An <b>Admin key</b> ( <code>sk-admin-...</code> ) for the organization costs & usage endpoints |
| Gemini (AI Studio) | X <b>impossible</b>    | No usage/billing API exists for API keys at all — only GCP Cloud Billing export + OAuth        |
| OpenRouter         | ✓ <b>works fully</b>   | Nothing — a normal <code>sk-or-...</code> key reports spend and balance                        |

## 2 Fix 1 — locally measured usage

RECOMMENDED · ALREADY WIRED IN

### The "Measured locally" panel on the Anthropic provider page

Several in-house desktop tools write to a shared usage ledger: each one records the **exact usage block returned by the API on every call** into

```
%APPDATA%\LiftedPDFTools\api_usage*.jsonl
```

These are real token counts straight from Anthropic — not estimates — and the panel reads them live: past 24 hours / 7 days / 30 days / lifetime spend, broken down per app. Each app also has its own analytics page, and Stage 2's page adds a per-tool breakdown.

**Coverage:** every call made through those apps on this machine. What it can't see: calls made with the same key from other machines or tools. For a single-PC workflow this is effectively complete.

### 3 Fix 2 — an Anthropic Admin key

ORGANIZATION ACCOUNTS ONLY

1. Go to **console.anthropic.com** → **Settings** → **Organization** → **API keys**.
2. Create a key with the **Admin** role — it will start `sk-ant-admin...` . (If you never see an Admin option, your account is an individual account and Anthropic does not offer admin keys for it — use Fix 1.)
3. In this app: **API Keys** → **Add key**, paste the admin key — it is auto-detected from the prefix.
4. Refresh — cost & usage now come from Anthropic's own organization reports (org-wide, all keys, all machines).

**Treat an admin key like a password:** it can read org-wide billing. Prefer a spend-capped, analytics-only workflow and never paste it into other tools.

**OpenAI:** same idea — create an Admin key ( `sk-admin-...` ) from platform.openai.com → Settings → Organization → Admin keys, then add it here.

**Gemini:** no key-based option exists. Track spend via Google Cloud Billing budgets/exports, or route Gemini calls through OpenRouter (whose key reports usage properly).

### 4 Which numbers should I trust?

**Admin-key numbers** — authoritative org-wide billing, all machines.

**Locally measured numbers** — exact for everything done through the desktop apps on this PC, blind to anything else.

If both are present they differ exactly by usage from outside this machine — that difference is itself useful information.

### 5 Known gap that remains

Even with an admin key, charts backfill only from the moment a key is added — the adapters don't implement history backfill, so day-one charts start sparse and fill as snapshots accumulate.